Hotline Etheria

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/40410480.

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Mature

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Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018), Hotline Miami (Video Games)

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by reignofrykthhl

Summary

Catra gets called into work.

Thematic crossover with the Hotline Miami Franchise.

Rated for violence similar to the Hotline Miami Franchise.

Do NOT post to any other sites. AO3 will be the only place this story is hosted.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Catra wakes up in a daze. Her head heavy, she lifts herself from her resting position and groans while stretching her arms. She takes a peek at the neon green digits of the clock through her blurry vision:

2:00 AM

Letting out an even bigger sigh, she gets out of bed, lightly slapping herself to wake up. Catra makes her way to the bathroom, opening the door. Her eyes widen a little, and she realizes that-

BBRRRRRIIING!

The feline-humanoid jumps, hitting her head on the frame with a yelp. The phone continues its ringing, the noise burrowing into her ears as she massages her temples. She nervously paces over and grabs the phone, years of dust particles sprinkling off. Catra's hand shakes as she puts the gray phone to her ear.

"H- Hello?" she lets out weakly.

Nothing responds for a moment, but she can hear a slow rumbling noise from the other end. Then, a low, rhythming pounding. She squints and puts the phone closer to her ears, sweat rolling down her face. The pound gets louder, and she realizes it's a deep voice, cackling.

"Who is this? Why are you calling me?" an angry voice demands. Catra can't make out the voice. It sounds like three people talking at once.

"Wh- what? You called me!" she yells back, louder than intended.

"Oh no, you would not be on this phone if you weren't calling back. I didn't even realize that you wanted to be back. But it is what it is. Do you even remember me?"

Catra blinks.

“Of course not. That’s to be expected, of course. However, pleasantries aside, you’ll be receiving some important articles soon. One of our friends needs your help. They will be giving you the details soon.”

Catra stares at her door. Her breathing gets faster and her head begins aching again.

“Oh, and Catra,” the voice morphs into one, sounding notably deep and feminine, “do not disappoint me, my dear.”

Catra screams herself out of bed, falling onto the floor. She gets up in a panic and looks at the clock:

3:00 PM

She breathes in and out, trying to slow her heart rate.

“What the fuck was that?” She says to her clock, expecting an answer.

It continues to tick in response.

“Yeah, thought so.”

Ten minutes later, the cat found herself walking on the streets, brisk air hitting her face. Despite being the afternoon, few people were roaming the town. The few people she made eye contact with quickly averted their gazes.

One stranger gave her a particularly nasty look, and in the process of hissing at them, Catra nearly fell forward, a note flying out from somewhere on her person.

With one swift move, she grabs and opens it:

Hey there, Wildcat!

I know it's been a while, but there's a job for you again!
It's great to have a reason to say hi after all this time! We all really miss you, and we hope you can make it down here once in a while.

Anyway, the job is simple. Janitorial services tonight at Etherian's. Get there at about 9:30 PM after close, and you can bring your own gear for it. We'll handle the rest once you're out, since they want this to be as quick as possible.

Catch ya later!

Suddenly, a piercing migraine hits Catra and she grasps and claws at her pulsing head. She starts swearing and the migraine gets worse as Catra falls to the floor. A random passerby tries to help her up but Catra continues her guttural screaming and kicks them.

"I can't do it! I can't do it! Fuck, FUCK, FUCK!" she shouts, a sizable crowd now surrounding her. She thrashed and squirmed, a whine suddenly entering her ears.

In the crowd, someone holding a data pad presses the screen. In an instant, Catra's migraine goes away. The passerby, dressed in light pink, pushes everyone aside.

"Everyone step back! I got this!" They bellow out with a deep, masculine voice. The crowd predictably parts for the stranger.

Catra feels herself get lifted up, her vision blurry and only seeing a slightly pink mass carry her. She can't make out their face, and their voice makes its way into her ears.

"C'mon, we gotta get you prepped for your job. Sorry about that earlier, but you've been out of the job so long that we weren't sure if you were calibrated. Here's some water, and I'll get you a better spot to rest."

Catra feels water trickle into her mouth before she blacks out.

Crunch, crunch, crunch…

The magicat is stepping on gravel as she comes to full awareness. Frantically looking around, she sees that it's dark out, and the glow of a hardware store is shining on her face.

<u>Etherian's.</u>

Catra feels the weight of a backpack, and she opens it and picks out a familiar red metal mask, with a small note taped to it.

Hi Cat!

Thought you'd need this. Should help with getting back into it! Remember, get this done fast, we can take care of the cleanup after.

She dons the mask, enters the store, and is met with the robotic ring of an entrance doorbell. Catra instantly feels the presence of others, spotting at least five humanoid figures milling about the aisles. One of them spots her and starts to whisper to another.

The cat walks over to the glowing pharmacy, noting the gray and green suits each of them are wearing. She just misses one turn, a hand-drawn red symbol in the form of two wings with a diamond between them.

At the counter is a sweating employee, who stares at Catra as she walks up.

"So… everything alright?" she asks.

The employee looks to Catra's left and right, and beads of sweat drip on his face while he slowly nods.

Catra's ears and tail perk up, and she ducks as-

CRACK! CRACK!

Two gunshots narrowly avoid her, and she turns to see a couple of the earlier dregs pointing smoking pistols. The sweating employee walks slowly backwards.

There's a second of breathing for all of them.

Catra leaps forward, headbutting the one on the left and knocking the gun out of his hands. The other panics and tries to shoot, but Catra sidesteps it. She feels trickles of blood splash behind her as she claws the other one's chest. He screams in pain, but she gives a kick directly to his head to knock him out cold.

Her blood begins a warm boil and she looks at the employee from earlier. He is fearfully backing up more, but hits a rack of supplies. She walks up to him and gracefully hops over the counter, fists curled up. She feels the heat in her blood get hotter and presses one of her hands around his neck.

"Who. The fuck. Are you?" she spits into his face with all the venom she can muster.

"For the grace of Hor-!" he shouts as he pulls a knife from his pocket. Catra reacts by punching him in the center of his face, and his head recoils and slams into the rack. He falls onto the floor like a ragdoll, Catra noting the blood leaking out from the back of his head.

She hears footsteps run over and ducks below the counter.

"Shit! Who the hell did this?"

"Hell if I know, you scout this area, I'll gather some of the boys and make sure there's no escape. We'll keep the others in the aisles."

Footsteps go away.

"Where the hell are you? Come out and make our lives easier. We can even make it fast!"

Catra tenses as the owner of the voice approaches the counter. She flinches as the barrel of a gun hovers over her.

The man doesn't even have time to react as Catra grabs the gun and pulls it down, causing the man's face to hover over her.

"What the-" Catra buts the end of the gun onto his face.

He recoils in pain, and she quickly hops over the counter again and uses the shotgun as a club, striking him in the side of his temple. His screaming ceases and his body THUDS onto the floor.

Catra hastily makes her way to an aisle, scrambling up and causing some tools to fall to the floor with a crash. She puts her body flush to the top of the aisle, and hears two sets of footsteps rush over.

"Shit, John, what the fuck is going on?"

"I don't know, but we've gotta call this one in. The others are still at their posts."

As the one named John puts his hand in his pocket, Catra jumps back down onto the other one's back. She grabs the gun from the fallen one's hand and tosses it at John's arm, knocking the gun away.

As John yelps, she grabs his throat and squeezes, causing the man to gurgle at his crushed windpipe.

BANG!

Catra yelps in pain as a bullet tears through the edges of her shoulder. Turning with a glare, she spots another henchman, sweating and holding a pistol.

Red magic begins to form around her body, the magicat's eyes turning a crimson red. The goon fails to pull the trigger in time before Catra dives and plants her claws deep into his chest.

Footsteps approach the two and Catra puts her back to an aisle, inching her way over with a hand opened outward. The collar of another henchman appears and she reaches out, grabbing the man and turning him into a standing headlock.

He struggles and writhes as two more show up, guns pointed. They hesitate for a second.

Catra tilts her head forward and gives an evil smirk. She cuts her hostage's neck and tosses his body forward, the two thugs firing inaccurate shots as the cat rushes forward. She uses a part of the aisle to jump upward and use a foot to kick into one guard. He crashes into the floor with an audible CRACK directly onto his spine.

She uses the momentum of the fall to make a dive at the other guard, making three swift diagonal cuts at his chest. His body rhythmically twists in the air to each swipe before collapsing on the floor. Catra takes a second to breathe in and out. She looks at the fallen thug and sees through his ripped shirt a torn-up red logo. She can only partially see the shape of a pair of wings-

Catra jumps at the sound of sirens approaching. She hastily sprints over to the employee exit as the front doors swarm with police. Once outside, she clambers up to the roof of the store and begins hopping across the neighboring buildings to get away.

Across the street, a figure dressed in a set of white-gold protective gear and a helmet stares at Catra jumping across buildings. When she's out of sight, they pull out a datapad, inputting some information.

They hit a button on their wrist and vanish in a flash of pink light.

Catra wakes up in another stupor, but this time she feels particularly dehydrated. Groggily opening her eyes, she recounts her events last night, especially getting shot-

In a panic she reaches for the spot on her shoulder.

There’s a slight mark, but no soreness or pain.

With a sigh of relief, Catra also spots the small envelope on her bed. Opening it, she gets up and reads it while walking.

Hi Wildcat!

Great job yesterday! I knew you had it in you to get back to it, you star performer!

A-plus jobs aside, we found it interesting that you didn’t really use any guns for once, but hey, to each their own.

We appreciate the work you’re doing.

It’s for the honor of Grayskull.

Catra shakes her head around and rubs her eyes at the last line:

It’s for the honor of us all.

Deciding she’s still too tired to read anything, Catra dives at her bed, sleep overtaking her once again.

In a room, three voices discuss.

“What a wonderful job she did, no?” a positive and spry voice asks.

“Perhaps under your standards. My dear is capable of much more.” Another responds.

“She got it done! What more do you want from her?”

“I want her to be the best. It’s what I strived for her! And she was ungrateful, running off with Ado-”

“Quiet!” A third, younger voice cuts in. The other two hold their breath nervously. “We can’t keep her on the job if you two keep butting heads like idiots.”

“So, what do we do now?” The first voice asks sheepishly.

The young voice thinks.

“We watch her closely. Tell her what she wants to know and wants to hear. She’s still the key to defeating his remnants. But we can’t do that if she feels any suspicion.”

“So what about our- her friends?” The first voice asks.

“We have to keep them away.” The third voice curtly replies.

“But they’re our-”

“I said they stay away!”

“--”

The second voice chimes in.

“You know, she is right. This is most distressing, as we all have some connection to them all. But if Catra is distracted from the goal, we risk losing more than just old acquaintances.”

“Easy for you to say, they broke contact with you twice. And for one of them, you were dea-”

“Silence! My personal history has little to do with our mission. I request we meet again later, before we get out of hand. We know what we need to do.”

“Okay.”

“Works for me.”

Catra stirs in her sleep.

Inside a musty blue apartment sits one anonymous figure. Their golden helmet is on the table, and the static of TV permeates the

room with a white noise. They're gripping a bottle and staring at the wall adjacent to the TV, red strings and pins adorning it.

They get up, and stare at the wall for a second. At the center is a picture of Catra. The person peels off the photo and thumbs the photo.

"I'm coming, Catra. I promised I would."

End Notes

Thanks for reading my fic everyone! This was a concept run to see how well I'd be able to write and adapt two worlds into one.

It's my first published fic on any of the sites in nearly a decade. Excited to be back and write!

Not quite used to the system of formatting text yet, so I'll get to fixing spots that need to be centered/italicized/bolded.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!